

Reading	Vocabulary & Use your English	Grammar	Listening	Total
/ 6	/ 26	/ 23	/ 5	/ 60

Reading

/ 6

Read the article about Kirsten Bruhn.

Inspiring others to achieve something special

Although not internationally famous, Kirsten Bruhn has provided inspiration to many through her sporting achievements. She was born in north Germany and her family had always been keen swimmers, so it was not surprising that by the age of ten, Kirsten had already competed in several swimming events. **(1)** One of them was to move to Hamburg to follow her dream and study graphic design. But her life was about to change dramatically.

Kirsten and a friend were on a motorcycle trip on the island of Kos in Greece. They had been riding up a steep mountain when her friend lost control of the bike and it went off the road. As soon as she opened her eyes, Kirsten realised that she was unable to move. She was flown back to hospital in Germany where they found her back was badly injured. **(2)** At the end of these it became clear that she would have difficulty walking again. The devastating news marked the beginning of a new chapter in Kirsten's life.

At first, she thought about all the things she would miss out on because of the accident, such as running and dancing. Although she did eventually learn to walk a little with support, her movement was severely limited. Kirsten understood this right from the start but never completely accepted it. **(3)** The pool was a place where she felt comfortable and was able to move more freely than anywhere else.

During her two-year rehabilitation period, she worked hard, although swimming had now become a way of staying fit and mobile rather than the competitive activity it had been before her accident. She came up with a personalised training programme that allowed her to build up strength in her legs, which had badly damaged nerves from the accident. However, her wish to

remain active was so strong that she began to look for an opportunity to swim in races again.

(4) From there, she never looked back, and numerous German national titles were followed by Paralympic gold medals. It was a period of great personal success and pride for her family.

Although swimming took priority in her life, Kirsten was also able to develop a career as a health insurance specialist. She was lucky to have an employer who allowed her time off to continue her sport training. And despite having to abandon her original dream of becoming a graphic designer, she remains a very creative person. **(5)** She saw this creative activity as a way of taking a break from the water, where she was training six times a week.

Kirsten's motto is 'Do not dream your life, live your dreams.' **(6)** She usually explains to them that feeling fit and happy in the water has had a positive effect on other areas of her life such as her creativity. Her influence and inspiration look set to increase in the future: she has promised her father (also her former coach) that she will become a swimming trainer when she retires from competitions.

EXAM TASK

Six sentences have been removed from the article. Choose from the sentences A–G the one which fits each gap (1–6). There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use.

- A** Her solution was to return to swimming.
- B** Evidence of this can be found in the T-shirts and jewellery that she has designed, as well as some impressive oil paintings.
- C** Several operations were carried out over several months.
- D** This came in 1992 when, with encouragement from a swimming colleague, she entered her first sports competition for people with disabilities.
- E** Her energy and sense of fun mean she is looked up to as a role model, particularly by young people who have suffered life-changing events similar to hers.
- F** None of this, however, had prepared her for what was going to happen next.
- G** After finishing high school and spending a year in the US as an au pair, she began planning her next steps.

Write your answers (A–G) for gaps 1–6:

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____
- 4 _____
- 5 _____
- 6 _____

1 Complete the sentences with the correct form of the words given.

/ 10

1. My brother isn't very _____, at my old school in Valencia he never knew what he wanted to do in life. *AMBITION*
2. Thanks to my _____, my English has really improved this year. *DETERMINE*
3. Teachers should give _____ to students who try their best. *ENCOURAGE*
4. Some people aren't very good at dealing with _____. *FAIL*
5. Being _____ probably isn't as nice as most people think it is. *FAME*
6. My friend's aunt is a rich and _____ businesswoman. *INFLUENCE*
7. My boss tried to make an _____ speech, but I think most people were bored. *INSPIRE*
8. I'm sorry, I didn't _____ it was your birthday today. *REAL*
9. Footballers and other sports stars can make a lot of money through _____ deals. *SPONSOR*
10. If at first you don't _____, keep trying. *SUCCESS*

2 Choose the correct option (a–c) to complete the sentences.

/ 8

1. Ethan has his own successful company, and he's only 25. What's the **a) legend / b) mystery / c) secret** of his success?
2. Some people laughed when Gina hit her leg on the table, but she didn't see the funny **a) side / b) part / c) way**.
3. I used to love cycling, but I've lost my **a) passion / b) joy / c) celebration** for it recently.
4. I didn't tell anyone it was my birthday yesterday because I didn't want to **a) bring / b) draw / c) make** attention to myself.
5. I asked Noah why he hadn't done his homework, and he **a) came / b) invented / c) made** up with a silly excuse about his dog eating it.
6. In the last minute, the player **a) caught / b) held / c) seized** the chance to kick the ball in the goal, scored, and won the match.
7. I keep trying to start this book, but I never **a) begin / b) get / c) go** anywhere and stop reading after a few pages.
8. There's a perfume that I always put on – it isn't a **a) home / b) family / c) household** name, but I think it's very good.

3 Complete the Exam Task: read the text and think of the word which best fits each gap. Use only one word in each gap.

18

Being the oldest of three children had some advantages when I was growing up, in a small town near Valencia. My two younger sisters often looked (1)_____ to me, for example, because I seemed so much cooler and wiser. But there were disadvantages, too. I always had to (2)_____ a good example and seem like I was being the responsible older child. My parents wouldn't let me get away (3)_____ things like leaving my room in a mess, or staying out late. That meant I missed (4)_____ on some things that my friends were doing, like going to parties at the weekend, or going to festivals.

I had to stay at home and babysit my sisters while my parents went out instead. When I went to university, I was leading the (5)_____ in my family – none of my relatives had gone. It was hard in a way, because I didn't have any role models in my family to follow, and I didn't have anyone to ask for advice. In my first year there, I spent a lot of time making new friends and having fun. It made up (6)_____ all the times I couldn't go out with friends when I was living with my parents. But it meant I had to work extra hard to (7)_____ up on all the work I'd missed.

But it seemed I was like a role model to my two younger sisters. They felt like they had to follow (8)_____ my footsteps, and go to university, too. One of them is now studying for her PhD and will become a doctor one day. I feel proud of her, but I'm not really sure that I have anything to do with her success!

1 Complete the Exam Task: complete the second sentence so it has a similar meaning to the first, using the word given (2-5 words, including the word given). / 6

1. The rain stopped before we got there.

BY

The rain _____ the time we arrived.

2. He was a successful actor by the age of 25.

BECOME

By the age of 25, _____ a successful actor.

3. He went to the theatre for the first time yesterday.

NEVER

He _____ to the theatre before yesterday.

4. She was looking for a long time, and then she found the restaurant.

BEEN

She _____ a long time before she found the restaurant.

5. The concert started at 7 p.m., and we arrived at 7.15 p.m.

ALREADY

When we arrived, the concert _____

6. He felt as if he needed a break after studying all day.

HAD

He _____, so he felt that he needed a break.

2 Choose the correct option to complete the sentences.

/ 9

1. I met / had been meeting my friend Emilia in Valencia yesterday.
2. Before I finally found my keys, I looked / had been looking for them for hours.
3. The film started / had started as soon as I sat down in the cinema.
4. When I read / had read the email, I waited a minute, and then started writing a reply.
5. I wasn't used to living in a busy city because I always lived / had always lived in a small town.
6. I knew who the man was because we had met / had been meeting each other once before.
7. I sat / had been sitting on the train for fifteen minutes before I realised I was on the wrong one.
8. Sara had worked / had been working all day, and she still hadn't finished by 10 p.m.
9. I arrived / had arrived five minutes late for school this morning. My teacher wasn't angry, though.

3 Complete the sentences with the past simple, past perfect or past perfect continuous form of the verbs. / 8

1. I was sitting in the living room when I _____ (hear) a loud noise from the next room. I went to see what _____ (happen).
2. I _____ (fall) asleep at nine o'clock last night. I _____ (watch) a film, but it was so boring I switched it off and went to bed.
3. I _____ (not eat) sushi before today. I _____ (like) it a lot.
4. I was exhausted when I got home yesterday evening. I _____ (look) round the shops for five hours and I _____ (not buy) a single thing.

EXAM TASK

You will hear five short extracts in which people talk about meeting someone famous. For questions 1–5, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says about the experience. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

- A** Surprisingly, the person didn't know how to do something.
- B** This person was much friendlier than many people say.
- C** I finished the meeting thinking much less of this person.
- D** This person gave me some useful information.
- E** The person I spoke to seemed quite shy.
- F** I couldn't wait to get away from the person.
- G** I shouldn't have started talking to this person.
- H** After meeting this person, I decided that I never wanted to become famous.

- 1. Speaker 1 _____
- 2. Speaker 2 _____
- 3. Speaker 3 _____
- 4. Speaker 4 _____
- 5. Speaker 5 _____

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